Jean Barré

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Computational literary scholar combining literary theory with NLP and machine learning to study how narrative forms emerge, circulate, and change across large corpora. Postdoctoral researcher at the Max Planck Institute for Empirical Aesthetics (Frankfurt) in the ERC project *Macroevolution of European Literature* (MELT). PhD in Computational Literary Studies defended June 5, 2026 at the École Normale Supérieure – PSL, under the supervision of Thierry Poibeau and Thomas Conrad.

PhD thesis: *Modeling Genre Fiction: Computational Methods and Generic Evolution in French-Language Fiction.* Focus on detective and adventure fiction from the late 19th to the mid-20th century; methods include large-scale corpora, fine-tuned vector-space models, and character-network analysis.

Born: 11.12.1999
Languages: French (native), English (C1), some German, some Spanish

Programming: Python, R, SQL, bash, Slurm, LaTeX
Skills: text mining, data engineering, ML, LLM fine-tuning & evaluation

Tools: Git, Linux, Jean Zay (HPC), Scikit-Learn, PyTorch, HuggingFace, spaCy, Gensim, NetworkX, Plotly, Pandas

Research interests: computational literary studies, literary history, literary theory, genre evolution, intertextuality, network analysis, stylometry, cultural evolution

Professional and Educational History

from Nov 2026	**Postdoctoral Researcher** – Max Planck Institute for Empirical Aesthetics, Frankfurt Research Group *Cultural Evolution of the Arts* (O. Sobchuk); ERC project *Macroevolution of European Literature* (MELT)
2025–2026	**Research Software Engineer** (fixed-term) – CNRS – LaTTiCe, Paris Development of NLP methods for large-scale literary corpora; completion of doctoral research
2022–2026	**PhD in Computational Literary Studies** – LaTTiCe, École Normale Supérieure – PSL, Paris Supervisors: T. Poibeau (LaTTiCe) and T. Conrad (République des Savoirs) – Defended: June 5, 2026
2021–2022	**Student Research Assistant** to T. Poibeau – CNRS – LaTTiCe, Paris
2020–2022	**MSc in Digital Humanities** – École nationale des Chartes, PSL University
2017–2020	**BA in French Literature** – Sorbonne University
2017–2020	**BSc in Computer Science** – Sorbonne University

Publications

Journal Articles

Barré, J..
"Hors d'usage: Curated French Fiction from Gallica, 1800–1950."
Journal of Open Humanities Data, vol. 12, no. 116, 2026. doi:10.5334/johd.597

Bourgois, A.; **Barré, J.**; Seminck, O.; Poibeau, T.
"Toward an Ontological Representation of Fictional Characters."
Journal of Computational Humanities Research, Feb. 2026. doi:10.1017/chr.2026.10025

Mélanie-Becquet, F.; **Barré, J.**; Seminck, O.; Plancq, C.; Naguib, M.; Pastor, M.; Poibeau, T.
"BookNLP-fr, the French Versant of BookNLP. A Tailored Pipeline for 19th and 20th Century French Literature."
Journal of Computational Literary Studies, Nov. 2024. doi:10.48694/jcls.3924

Barré, J.; Camps, J.-B.; Poibeau, T.
"Operationalizing Canonicity: A Quantitative Study of French 19th and 20th Century Literature."
Journal of Cultural Analytics, vol. 8, no. 3, 2023. doi:10.22148/001c.88113

Conference Articles

Barré, J.
"Birth of the Detective, Birth of a Genre."
Digital Humanities (DH 2026), Seoul, South Korea. hal-05623518

Barré, J.
"In Search of Lost Adventure Novels."
ACL – NLP4DH 2026, San Diego, USA. hal-05620913

Barré, J.; Seminck, O.; Bourgois, A.; Poibeau, T.
"Modeling the Construction of a Literary Archetype: The Case of the Detective Figure in French Literature."
CHR 2025, Esch-sur-Alzette. arXiv:2511.00627

Brottrager, J.; **Barré, J.**; Bizzoni, Y.; Feldkamp-Moreira, P.
"Patterns of Canon: A Multilingual Network Study."
CHR 2025, Esch-sur-Alzette.

Gabay, S.; **Barré, J.**; Cafiero, F.
"The times are a-changin': présent vs passé simple in French novels (1811–2020)."
DH Benelux 2025, Amsterdam. hal-04984105

Barré, J.
"Latent Structures of Intertextuality in French Fiction."
CHR 2024, Aarhus. arXiv:2410.17759

Chen, N.; Mélanie-Becquet, F.; **Barré, J.**; Poibeau, T.
"Network Analysis, Plot Theory: Revisiting French Literature through Character Networks."
DH 2024, Washington. hal-04855204

Barré, J.
"Détection automatique de l'architextualité dans le roman d'aventures."
Humanistica 2024, Meknès. hal-04559749

Barré, J.; Poibeau, T.
"Beyond Canonicity. Modeling Canon/Archive Literary Change in French Fiction."
CHR 2023, Paris. hal-04279087

Vianne, L.; Dupont, Y.; **Barré, J.**
"Gender Bias in French Literature."
CHR 2023, Paris.

Barré, J.; Cabrera-Ramirez, P.; Mélanie-Becquet, F.; Galleron, I.
"Pour une Détection Automatique de l'Espace Personnage dans les Romans."
Humanistica 2023, Geneva. hal-04105537

Full list and open-access versions: jeanbarre.eu/publications | Google Scholar | HAL

Software and Technical Contributions

Propp-fr	End-to-end NLP pipeline for full-length French novels: NER, long-distance coreference resolution (>100k words), character-attribute extraction. French adaptation of BookNLP for 19th–20th c. literature. github.com/lattice-8094/propp – published in the *J. of Computational Literary Studies* (2024)
Literary sentence transformers	Fine-tuned sentence-embedding models for French literature (19th–20th c.). Adaptation of BGE-m3 on a literary corpus to capture stylistic and thematic proximities specific to fiction. huggingface.co/crazyjeannot/fr_literary_bge_base
Detective classifier	Supervised classifier (with CamemBERT embeddings) for automatic detection of detective characters. Trained on annotated characters, 92% balanced accuracy, robust across authors

	and periods. github.com/lattice-8094/DETECTIVES – published at CHR 2025
Refined Gallica corpus	11,344 French novels from Gallica (BnF), cleaned and enriched with metadata. OCR-quality filtering and deduplication for 19th–20th c. fiction; adventure and detective sub-corpora. doi:10.5281/zenodo.20233178 – published in the *J. of Open Humanities Data* (2026)

Grants & Awards

2025 **Young Researcher Visiting Grant** (€2,000) – DFG Priority Programme "Computational Literary Studies"
Research stay at the Würzburg DH Lab under Prof. Fotis Jannidis

Teaching

As Course Instructor

Fall 2025	**Récit et Argumentation** (24h) – L1 Lettres Modernes (LLFL), Sorbonne Nouvelle
Fall 2025	**Applied NLP for Computational Literary Studies** (20h) – CPES *Data, Arts and Cultures*, Lycée Louis-le-Grand / PSL
Fall 2025	**Python for Computational Humanities** (24h) – École nationale des Chartes, MSc Digital Humanities
Spring 2025	**Applied NLP for Computational Literary Studies** (20h) – CPES, PSL
Fall 2024	**Python for Computational Humanities** (24h) – École nationale des Chartes, MSc Digital Humanities
March 2024	**Using Large Language Models to Study Fiction** (20h) – *DH meet AI*, PSL intensive week
Fall 2023	**Python for Computational Humanities** (24h) – École nationale des Chartes, MSc Digital Humanities
Nov. 2022	**A Computational Literary History of Gender in French Fiction** (20h) – *DH meet AI*, PSL intensive week

As Teaching Assistant

Spring 2024 & 2025	**Computational Literary Studies**, with F. Cafiero – ENS-PSL
Fall 2024	**Natural Language Processing**, with T. Poibeau – École nationale des Chartes

Scientific Activities

Reviewer for: *Computational Humanities Research* (journal and conference), *Computational Literary Studies* (journal and conference), *Humanistica*.

Events organized:

- *Le texte de l'autre. Dialogue interdisciplinaire autour de l'intertextualité et du discours rapporté*, conference, July 1–3, 2025, Paris. intertextualite.sciencesconf.org
- *AI and Large Language Models (LLMs) for the Analysis of Large Literary Corpora*, workshop, December 5, 2023, Paris. workshop-llms4cls.github.io
- *LaTTiCe PhD Presentation Day*, study day (2023, 2024, 2025, 2026), Montrouge.

Collective responsibilities:

- Participation in the pedagogical design of the MSc in Digital Humanities, École nationale des Chartes; member of the admissions panel.
- Doctoral students' representative on the LaTTiCe laboratory committee.

Selected talks and conferences: CHR (2023, 2024, 2025), DH (2022, 2024, 2026), Humanistica (2023, 2024), CCLS (2024), NLP4DH (2026).